

Build Windows Vista Applications

With Visual Studio 2008, developers will be easily able to leverage new platform technologies and deliver more compelling applications to their customers. Visual Studio enables customers to effortlessly incorporate new Windows Presentation Foundation features into both existing Windows Forms applications and new applications.

Developers can also move their applications to the new Windows Vista *look and feel* easily with enhancements to MFC and Visual C++®.

Visual Studio offers developers key improvements such as:

- Enable the construction of *rich experience* Windows applications
 - Visual Studio provides tools that enable developers who are early adopters of Windows Presentation Foundation to build *rich experience* applications quickly and easily. These tools include a designer and XAML editor, project templates, debugging support, deployment support, etc.
- Easily add the Windows Vista *look and feel* to native C++ applications
 - Developers can use Visual Studio to build applications that exhibit the Windows Vista *look and feel* and take advantage of the more than 8,000 new native APIs available in Windows Vista. A number of the Windows Vista *look and feel* features are available simply by recompiling an MFC application. Deeper integration that requires more coding or design work on the part of the developer is also simplified with Visual Studio's integrated support for the Windows Vista native APIs.
- Office 2007 UI style support for native C++ applications
 - Visual Studio 2008 also provides developers with support for building applications that make use of the Microsoft Office 2007 UI style, including the Ribbon Bar, Ribbon Status Bar and Mini-toolbar.
- Improved interoperability between native and managed code
 - Visual Studio makes it easier to build applications that leverage both native and managed code, and also delivers improved interoperability performance. C++ developers have access to a new marshalling library that simplifies data transfer across the native-managed boundary STL/CLR for extending the Standard Template Library (STL) into managed code.